

Conversation

#09

CONVERSATION

I LOVE PARIS

Teacher's note: get 6 pieces of paper, number them 1 to 6 and have each student draw one, to see which character they will be. There are politically oriented characters in this conversation so, should any of your pupils be against the one they were drawn to role-play, don't force them and change their role. Also, every 10 minutes or so, pretend that they are at a specific place — like, say, the Louvre Museum. **Tourist 3**, in this case, would be very pleased. **Tourist 4**, the socialite, on the other hand, would throw a tantrum and refuse to leave the bus.

Today you are visiting Paris, second only to Rio de Janeiro, the most beautiful city in the world. You are a group of 6 people and you don't seem to be agreeing on where the bus you have chartered should take you first. In such a situation you are advised to use the modals **SHOULD**, **COULD**, and **MUST**.

1. Tourist 1: you are 19 and this is your first visit to a foreign country. It's also the first time you travel without mommy and daddy. You obviously think of yourself as a grown-up and you always lose your temper when the other tourists insist on calling you 'Kid'. Paris, for you, means cinemas and amusement parks. Museums and the like are for mummies.

2. Tourist 2: you are 89 and you have saved money all your life for this trip. You want to know the 'Capital of Love'. You always refer to Paris in French: 'Paris, l'amour toujours l'amour' (Paris, love, love forever). Though not typical of your age, going to parties, night clubs and Montmartre, the bohemian district of Paris — especially Place Pigalle and 'Le Moulin Rouge' — is all you want.

3. Tourist 3: you are 21 and Sociology is your dream. You came to Paris to visit the Sorbonne, the most charming university in the world. A hamburger is all your stomach needs, so French cuisine is for people who have time to waste eating. You want to see and experience museums and the rich French culture.

4. Tourist 4: you are 32 and a socialite. You cannot think of anything but going to the famous couturiers (dressmakers), like Yves Saint Laurent and Kenzo. Museums and amusement parks can be found anywhere, but proper clothing items only in Paris. Above all, how could you go back home and not bring a photo with the Eiffel Tower or the Arc de Triomphe in the background? Fair enough, they don't want to go shopping but you need at least an invoice from some posh shop on Rue de Rivoli to prove you went shopping in Paris. After all, as the ancient Romans used to say: 'Caesar's wife must not only be honest, it must also be proven that she is honest.' You must not only go shopping in Paris, you must prove that you did. You are here for clothes shopping and if the bus cannot take you where you want, you will walk. Only a fool would miss an opportunity for clothes shopping in Paris, even if it is only at the 'Gallerie Lafayette', where the lower classes go shopping.

5. Tourist 5: you are 39. You have just won the lottery (Mega Sena) and came to Paris to study 'French cuisine.' You want to run a restaurant in Búzios when you return and all you want is to learn how to captivate rich customers. Eating hamburgers in Paris is for the uncouth!

6. Tourist 6: you are 58 and a fierce leftist. You remember the riots in Paris in 1968, when people of your generation were trying to change the world, shortly before Lennon said 'The dream is over'. Well, Lennon has been dead for a long time and, definitely, the dream is NOT over. You want to spend all the time available at the Latin Quarter, the intellectual and leftist district of Paris and shout 'POWER TO THE PEOPLE' and 'VIVE LA RÉVOLUTION' until your lungs feel sore. Che lives, Elvis is dead, down with George Bush.

If time allows: switch roles, remembering what was said in the Teacher's Note.

Write either about the best place you have ever visited or the place you most want to visit and explain why.

Full name: _____

Theme: _____

Title: _____

[illegible]